

JIRA Defect Remediation & Tracking Project

Expedia Group BI Initiative | Ardenvale-Wood Consulting | May 2026

Project Name	JIRA Defect Remediation & Tracking Project
Project Manager	Ambrosia Ardenvale-Wood, Business Intelligence Consultant
Executives Sponsors	CIO & President of Technology
Date of Creation	May 2026

Executive Summary ☀

1,820 open bug-tier tickets identified across three severity tiers
Oldest open ticket: 5,836 days (16.0 years) without resolution
Estimated remediation cost: Base \$2,337,500 at blended \$125/hr engineering rate
353 tickets currently in Blocked status (structural workflow failure)
43.2% of all JIRA tickets remain open or unresolved across all issue types

1. Project Overview

Purpose | Problem Statement

Expedia Group’s global JIRA system has accumulated a monumental backlog of customer-reported bugs, technical defects, and operational issues spanning 16 years. The tickets are outstanding worldwide across hundreds of engineering and product teams. Due to significant inconsistency in issue type labels, achieving a reliable count, classification, and proper escalation of tickets has not reached appropriate leadership for resolution. The scope identifies all strategic initiatives needed to conquer this problem. The full JIRA dataset has been linked to the Expedia employee hierarchical map to achieve a comprehensive, classified, and budgeted examination of the open-bug backlog, and places these figures directly into the hands of accountable leadership for full-scale resolution.

Project Objectives

- Map out a unified bug taxonomy to classify all 17 JIRA issue types into 4 main task groupings (Direct Bugs, Customer Problems, Adjacent Issues & Non-Bug Work)
- Delineate total open-bug backlog, including ticket count, age distribution, and priority levels
- Join JIRA dataset to employee organizational hierarchy to connect VP and Director-level leadership with backlogs assigned to their respective teams
- Estimate total time and cost to remediate all open bug-tier tickets
- Deliver comprehensive resolution project scope to support executive action

Expected Outcomes | Success Criteria

- All 1,820 open bug-tier tickets are accessible and organized
- Each senior leader accountable to largest backlog groupings is identified
- Teams with ownership of high counts of 'Blocked' tickets are monitored for urgent workflow mitigation
- Justifiable cost estimate for remediation is calculated and presented to project sponsors
- A quarterly agreement is drawn up to review and address open-bug backlog stabilization

2. Scope

In Scope

- Tier 1 (Direct Bugs), Tier 2 (Customer Problems), or Tier 3 (Adjacent Issues) JIRA tickets
- Status items: 'In Progress', 'Blocked', 'To Do', 'Backlog', or 'In Review'
- Aging analysis, priority breakdown, department-level ticket assignment, and leadership governance reports
- Remediation cost estimation using Remaining Estimate (h) field for 100% coverage across all 1,820 open bug-tier tickets

Out of Scope

- All Tier 4 operational tickets
- Status items: 'Done' or 'Closed'
- Root cause analysis of bug origins

3. Stakeholders

Title	Team	Role	Responsibility
CIO / President of Technology	Engineering Leadership	Executive Co-Sponsors	Funds + spearheads BI initiative
VP, Product	Product & Design	CX Sponsor	Drives customer resolution impact across the organization
BI Consultant	Data & Analytics	Project Manager	Runs data pipeline, analysis, project plan
VPs of Engineering	Multiple Engineering Teams	Governance	Own ticket backlogs + responsible for outstanding ticket resolution
VP, Data & Analytics	Data & Analytics	Implementation	Works with BI Consultant, directs project implementation
Principal Software Engineer	Data Platform	Technical Advisor	Reviews + validates technical methodology/decisions
JIRA Administrator	IT Team	SME	Data exports + ticket configurations

4. Requirements & Deliverables

Deliverable	Description	Due Date	Status
Ticket Classification	17 JIRA types → 3 bug tiers	Wk1 D1	Done
Python Data Pipeline	Taxonomy, aging, dataset join, cost estimate	Wk1 D2	Done

Clean Datasets	Prepped for data visualization & leadership review	Wk1 D2	Done
Visualization Charts	Tiers, aging, accountability, priority, trend, manager upline allocation	Wk1 D2	Done
MIRO Process Map	End-to-end data flow chart	Wk1 D3	Done
Project Plan	Project document, risk plan, ROI estimate	Wk1 D5	Done
Executive Dashboard	Leadership dashboard	Wk2	In-process

5. Timeline & Milestones

Milestone	Description	Target Date	Status
Data Acquisition + EDA	Load + explore relevant datasets	Wk1 D1	Done
Bug Classification Defined	Map 17 issue types to 4 tiers, compared against Atlassian specifications	Wk1 D1	Done
Python Pipeline Created	Aging calculations, organization self-join, JIRA-employee match, cost estimate, CSV exports	Wk1 D2	Done
Leadership Charts Produced	(6) Professional charts exported to present findings	Wk1 D2	Done
MIRO Process Map Published	5-lane data flow diagram mapping out EDA process + key findings	Wk1 D3	Done
Project Plan Submitted	11-section comprehensive project document	Wk1 D5	Done
Leadership Presentation	Present plan to executive sponsorship + get commitment	Wk2	Planned
Interactive Dashboard Go-Live	Tableau executive dashboard published + shared with relevant stakeholders	Wk2	In-process
Team Status Tracking Plans Received	Each designated Engineering VP submits remediation plan for assigned ticket backlog	Wk4	Planned

6. Work Breakdown Structure

ID	Task	Owner	Start	End	Prior	Status
1.1	jira.csv + employee.csv EDA	BI Consultant	Wk1 D1	Wk1 D1	None	Done
1.2	JIRA bug classification	BI Consultant	Wk1 D1	Wk1 D1	1.1	Done
2.1	Build Python pipeline	BI Consultant	Wk1 D1	Wk1 D2	1.2	Done
2.2	Employee hierarchy self-join established	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.1	Done
2.3	JIRA to employee inputs analysis	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.2	Done
2.4	Identification of ticket aging	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.1	Done
2.5	ROI + cost estimation	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.3, 2.4	Done

2.6	Export cleaned + delineated datasets	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.5	Done
3.1	Produce (6) leadership charts	BI Consultant	Wk1 D2	Wk1 D2	2.6	Done
3.2	Build MIRO process map	BI Consultant	Wk1 D3	Wk1 D3	3.1	Done
3.3	Draft project plan	BI Consultant	Wk1 D3	Wk1 D3	3.2	Done
4.1	Build executive dashboard	BI Consultant	Wd2	Wk2	2.6	Planned
4.2	Leadership presentation deck	BI Consultant	Wk2	Wk2	3.1, 3.3	Planned
4.3	Collect VP ticket remediation plans	Executive Sponsors	Wk3	Wk4	4.2	Planned

7. Budget & Resources

Estimated Budget | Analysis Phase

BI Consultant billed at \$100 per hour + Delivery using existing tooling (Google Colab, Tableau, MIRO).

Remediation Budget

\$1.4M – \$3.3M in engineering labor, based on 18,700 remaining hours across 1,820 open bug-tier tickets, sourced directly from the JIRA Remaining Estimate field (100% coverage). The base case uses a blended rate of \$125/hr for a mid-level engineer.

Resource	Team / Vendor	Hours or Cost Estimate	Notes
BI Consultant	Data & Analytics	40 hours @ \$100/hr = \$4000	Analysis, pipeline, charts, dashboard, reporting
Google Colab	Google Workspace Enterprise	Existing enterprise license	Python notebook environment
Tableau	Salesforce	Existing enterprise license	Dashboard publishing
MIRO	MIRO	Existing enterprise license	Process mapping + stakeholder communication
Junior Engineering	Multiple Teams (TBD)	18,700 hours @ \$75/hr = \$1,402,500	Optimistic estimate
Mid-Level Engineering	Multiple Teams (TBD)	18,700 hours @ \$125/hr = \$2,337,500	Base estimate
Senior Engineering	Multiple Teams (TBD)	18,700 hours @ \$175/hr = \$3,272,500	Conservative estimate

8. Risks & Issues

This persistent bug ticket backlog, with some tickets approaching 16.0 years without resolution, requires remediation efforts that directly address all structural, cultural, and organizational dynamics contributing to the root cause(s).

ID	Risk / Issue	Impact	Likelihood	Owner	Mitigation Plan
R1	No accountability structure to ensure ticket resolution	High	Medium	CIO	Individual leaders assigned designated tickets + responsible for burn down.
R2	Rewards pertain to new features shipped, with no structural incentives for clearing defects as maintenance feature	High	High	President of Technology	Establish a KPI that guarantees 20% of sprint capacity devoted to bug resolution, with this metric predominant on all Leadership dashboards + reporting systems.
R3	Backlog untrackable due to inconsistent naming schema	High	High	JIRA Administrator	The 4-tier ticket classification structure created for this project (or some iteration thereof) should inform Expedia issue type naming schema going forward to track + burn down 100% of the backlog.
R4	353 Blocked tickets	High	High	Engineering VPs	Each assigned VP must own + audit assigned tickets and escalate unresolved dependencies in 30 days
R5	Tickets not assigned to any employee, lost in the system	High	Medium	BI Consultant + VP, Data & Analytics	Tickets assigned to termed employees + data quality issues causing unmatched tickets lack manager attribution. Lost tickets must be tracked regularly + assigned to appropriate Engineering VPs.

9. Communication Plan

Audience	Purpose	Method	Frequency	Owner
CIO / President of Technology + VP, Product	Executive summary: Total bug count, ongoing costs / ROI, team tracking, accountability	Slide Deck + Charts	Weekly until resolution schema approved; then quarterly	BI Consultant
Engineering VPs	Designated teams' open bugs, cost + aging breakdowns	Email + Tableau Dashboard	Bi-weekly	BI Consultant + Sponsors
Engineering Managers	Ticket-level views: Assigned, Blocked, overdue	JIRA filter + CSV export	Weekly during remediation sprints	VP Leads
Data & Analytics Team	Data pipeline updates, classification changes, dashboard enhancements	Slack + Colab Notebook	As needed	VP, Data & Analytics + BI Consultant
All Stakeholders	Monthly progress: Tickets closed, costs recovered, resolution detailed	Dashboard + email digest	Monthly	BI Consultant

10. Change Control

Changes to scope, schedule, cost, and accountability assignments must be approved through formal review process.

Change Request Process:

- Stakeholders submit change requests through the JIRA Service Management platform, to be received/processed by BI Consultant + Data & Analytics Team, including description of proposed change, business rationale, and estimated cost, time, and/or scope impact.
- Requests are evaluated within 72 business hours, and recommendation is handed off to Executive Sponsorship for approval.
- Formal approval by CIO or President of Technology must finalize before taking effect.
- Changes to ticket classification schema require approval from BI Consultant + JIRA Admin.
- Change log maintained by Data & Analytics Team.

11. Project Approval

By signing below, each stakeholder acknowledges they have thoroughly reviewed this project plan, and authorize the initiative to proceed as described throughout the full scope of this document.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Executive Co-Sponsor	CIO		
Executive Co-Sponsor	President of Technology		
CX Sponsor	VP, Product		
Project Manager	BI Consultant		
Implementation Team	VP, Data & Analytics		
Technical Advisor	Principal Engineer		
Subject Matter Expert	JIRA Administrator		

*This project plan was prepared by Ardenvale-Wood Consulting as part of the Expedia Group JIRA Defect Remediation & Tracking Initiative, May 2026.